Refrigerator and Freezer Storage Chart

COLD STORAGE
(FOR CONSUMERS)

This chart gives short, conservative storage times to protect you from food spoilage (what you risk in long refrigeration) and from taste loss (what happens when food is left too long in the freezer).

Product	Refrigerator (Days at 40°F)	Freezer (Months at 0°F)
Eggs		
liquid pasteurized eggs (unopened)	3 to 10	12
fresh in shell	21	don't freeze
raw yolk and whites	2 to 4	12
hard cooked	7	don't freeze
Fresh meats		
beef	3 to 5	6 to 12
lamb	3 to 5	6 to 9
pork	3 to 5	4 to 8
veal	3 to 5	4 to 8
hamburger	1 to 2	3 to 4
sausage	1 to 2	1 to 2
Cooked meats		
meat dishes	3 to 4	2 to 3
gravy, broth	1 to 2	2 to 3
Processed meat		
bacon	7	1
franks	7	1 to 2
ham	3 to 5	1 to 2
lunch meat	3 to 5	1 to 2
Fresh poultry (all)	1 to 2	6 to 9
Cooked poultry		
in broth	1 to 2	6
pieces	3 to 4	1
hotdish	3 to 4	4 to 6
fried chicken	3 to 4	4
Game		
deer	3 to 5	6 to 12
rabbit	1 to 2	12
duck, goose	1 to 2	6
Mayonnaise	60	don't freeze
TV dinners		6
Deli salad (egg, tuna, macaroni)	3 to 5	don't freeze
Soups, stews	3 to 5	2 to 3

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